2.1. Union Legislature: The Parliament

The Parliament is known as Union Legislature or National Legislature, which is a supreme body of decision making and symbol of democratic governance. The Parliament is the most powerful platform with accountability for debating on the issues regarding welfare of the country and its people and enacting laws and making changes to the constitution.

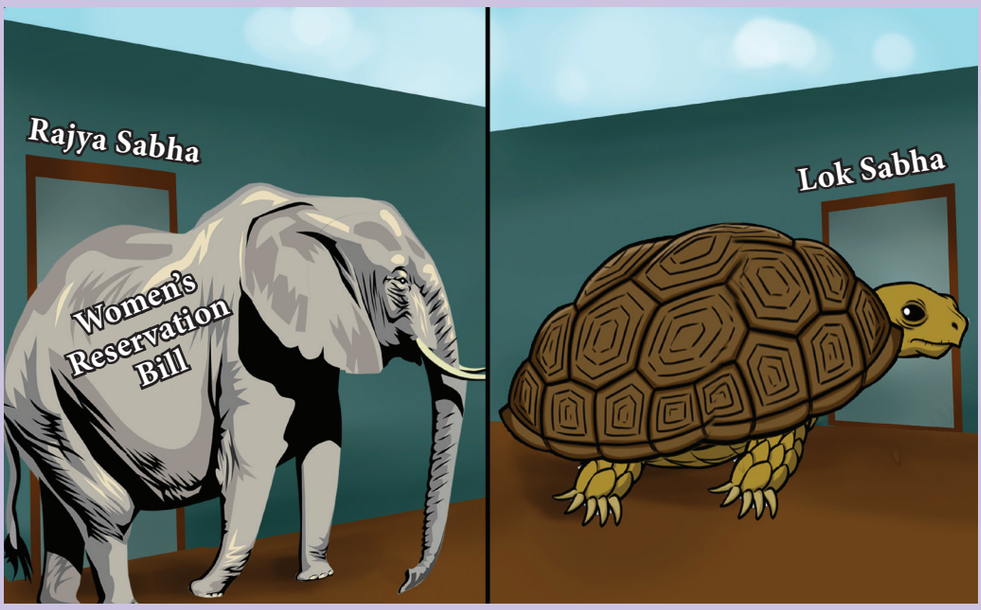
When the Parliament meet for discussing various agenda and approving bills, motions with a scheduled meeting is called session. The Parliament holds THREE sessions in a year.

1. Budget session (February-May)
2. Monsoon Session (July-August)
3. Winter Session (November-December

Activity - Interpretation of Cartoon

Women members in the Rajya Sabha urged the Government to ensure the passage of the Women's Reservation Bill in the Lok Sabha. The Bill, which proposes 33% reservation for women in Parliament and State legislatures, was passed by the Rajya Sabha in 2010 but has been stuck in the lower house for nine years.

The Constitution (108th Amendment) Bill, commonly known as the Women's Reservation Bill, needs to be approved by the Lok Sabha in order to become law.



Cartoon Courtesy : The Hindu, 13.3.2010.

As a class, discuss what you already know or think about the following topics:

a. Women's Reservation Bill

b. 33% quota

c. Needs to be approved by the Lok Sabha

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